

Speaker: Christian Rohrbeck (University of Bath)

Date: 09/10/2026 at 13:15 in 4 West 1.7 (Wolfson Lecture Theatre)

Title: A statistician's perspective on climate and environmental resilience

Abstract:

Climate and environmental resilience are increasingly important topics in science, policy, and industry, yet some of the terminology in this area may often seem unfamiliar to statisticians. This seminar will provide an introduction to the concepts commonly encountered in this research area, including hazards, exposure, vulnerability and resilience. The overall aim is not to cover advanced methods, but to provide some background that will help participants to engage more confidently with future events organised as part of the themed semester. Through examples, such as droughts and floods, we will explore how environmental hazards are characterised using observations, climate indices, and other statistical summaries. The seminar will also highlight some of the statistical challenges that arise in climate and environmental resilience research, including the analysis of extreme events, and examples from my own research, including work with PhD students, on environmental extremes will be used for illustration.